

Lesson 3: A Time of Transitions

Overview

Students explore the economic, agricultural, and social transitions caused by urbanization and the expansion of rail transportation at the turn of the century. Students learn how these changes to the landscape of Tłúpa still impact daily life today.

Estimated Delivery Time

1 50-minute session

Essential Question (EQ)

How did Euro-American settlement and urbanization change the physical and cultural landscape of Tłúpa? What aspects of the confederated tribes' relationships with Tłúpa have not changed and will never change?

Supporting Questions

What is land privatization and how is it a different perspective from the confederated tribes' understanding of living in relationship with the land?

Success Criteria

I am learning...

...how urbanization, industrialization, and land privatization changed the physical and cultural landscape of Tłúpa.

I will know I am successful when...

...I can identify examples of changes that occurred on primary source maps.

Ičışkíin Sínwit [Sahaptian Vocabulary]

[Link to interactive glossary.](#)

Lesson Vocabulary

[Link to interactive glossary.](#)

Background Information for Educators

Review background information prior to teaching the lesson.

(Direct links can be found in the online version of the lesson plan.)

- > Read [this Oregon Encyclopedia article](#) about the Oregon Railway & Navigation Company.
- > Read [this brief overview](#) of some of the changes brought by Industry and Agriculture in the Railroad Era.
- > Read [these excerpts from *The Echo Story*](#) compiled by Dr. John Woodward.
- > Listen to this *Confluence Story Gathering Podcast* episode titled, “[A Native Lens on Regenerative Ecosystems](#)” [30 mins]
Here’s [a transcription of the podcast](#) generated by [Vocova](#).

Materials Needed

Gather the following materials:

- > The whole class Know Wonder Learn (KWL) graphic organizer for ongoing assessment
- > “Tule Place Reflection Booklet” pages 11-13
- > [Slide deck with embedded video](#)
There is additional information in the “notes” section on the slideshows that may help you facilitate the lessons.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Part One: Warm Up (10 minutes)

1. Revisit KWL

- Use the KWL graphic organizer to revisit Indigenous understandings of relationship to Tkúpa as explored in lesson 2 including the concepts of the seasonal round...
 - What have we learned about Tkúpa so far?
 - What have we learned about the Indigenous Peoples' relationships to this place?

2. Story of Change

Talking point: *Let's listen to tribal elder, Bryson Liberty, share a story that his mother told him about her experiences one year heading down from the Blue Mountains towards their fishing places on the Columbia River...*

- Play the embedded video clip on slide 4 (~2 minutes)

Talking point: *This story describes how one spring, several Indigenous families were surprised to find a brand-new cabin built along their regular seasonal travel route. The non-Indigenous settlers who built and lived in that cabin were not friendly, so the families had to change the path they took back to the mountains after they were done fishing for the summer. Today we will explore some specific ways that non-Indigenous people settling at Tkúpa changed the Land and changed lives. We will also look for things that have stayed the same no matter what happens.*

Part Two: Lines on the Land

Talking Point: *We're going to look for evidence of these changes in historical maps. Before we start looking at maps, let's take a minute to review where we can find important information on maps!*

3. Introduce/refresh students' map reading skills with an overview of essential map components using Slide 5 as a guide. Be sure to check that they are familiar with the kinds of information found in each of the following components: Title, Orientation, Scale, Symbols, Colors, Legend or Key.

Talking Point: *Now we will look at some maps of the Umatilla River and Tkúpa. We are going to be searching for ways that the Land has changed and how those changes impacted people's lives.*

4. Show each of the maps on slides 7-14. (Slides 7 & 8 have animations to zoom in closer.)
 - For each map, ask one or two students to come up to the front of the class to look closely at each projected map to point out changes to the land or changes in relationships with the land shown on each map. Refer to the speaker notes section of the slides for detailed information to guide their inquiry.
 - During this time, students at their seats will record bullet points identifying changes to the land for each map. Use Tule Place Reflection Booklet pages 11-13 to encourage quality listening skills and focused attention during map observations.
 - The first set of maps (slides 7-11) show trends in categorizing and privatizing land.
 - The second set of maps (12-14) emphasize changes in land utilization and relationships

5. Lesson Closure/Wrap-Up

- Show the video embedded on slide 15 about the impacts of these cultural/landscape changes and how they led to the creation of this curriculum.
- Lead a short discussion about the video to reinforce the key ideas.
- Use the classroom KWL graphic organizer to write down newly acquired “learnings” from the map activity and the video. You can use additional time to have students record what they’ve learned on their own KWL page 3 within their Tule Place Teachings Reflection Booklet.

Assessment

Lesson can be assessed for the following:

- > Know Wonder Learn graphic organizer pages 1-3 in the Tule Place Reflection Booklet can be used to evaluate the new information students have recorded in the “learn” column.
- > Tule Place Reflection Booklet pages 11-13 identifying changes shown in maps

Support for All Students

Student supports include:

- > A scaffolded version of the booklet is available for students who would benefit from more structured guidance. This version is designated by the river icon on the cover page.
- > You can turn on closed captions for any of the videos to help students follow along. Transcripts are also available.

Extensions

Student extensions include:

- > Consider including the vocabulary from this lesson in other spelling or language practice by using the words in your regular spelling lessons or by having students make flashcards to practice acquiring new vocabulary.
- > This lesson provides a great connection to many potential geography lessons. After observing these maps and identifying the kinds of changes they illustrate, consider teaching students how to make their own map illustrating the changes they have seen.
- > The maps showing the names of migrants who own property in the Echo area can be used as an opportunity to discuss [the many cultures of people who chose to migrate to the Oregon Territory/State of Oregon](#). Students may even recognize some of the family surnames on the historical maps since many of these families have stayed in the community. Consider exploring the cultural contexts that have brought different ethnicities and races of people to this area of Oregon (Irish, Portuguese, German, Hispanic, Latino, etc.).
- > Math concepts of the Pythagorean theorem or trigonometry overall can be explored using the 1860 Chapman survey as a jumping-off point. This [Oregon](#)

[Public Broadcasting Video](#) describes early surveying and mapping in Oregon Territory and can be used to increase students' understanding of historical and modern applications of mathematics.

Oregon Grade 4 Social Science Standards (2024)

- 4.G.GR.1** Read and/or construct maps of the Northwest, Southwest, Midwest, Northeast, and Southeast, US Atlantic and Pacific Islands using a scale, compass, and key that includes important cities and physical features.
- 4.G.GR.3** Compare and contrast tribal, colonial, historical, and contemporary maps to understand Oregon's history.
- 4.G.MM.4** Compare and contrast varying patterns of exploration and settlement in the Pacific Northwest over time, considering how physical features and the availability of natural resources affected exploration and settlement patterns, including the development of major urban/suburban areas, industries, or trade.
- 4.G.HI.6** Assess how physical geography and changing environmental factors affect land use and shape the cultural characteristics of a society.
- 4.G.GE.7** Identify the effects on environmental stability and sustainability of technologies and policies such as dams, wind turbines, and transportation in shaping Oregon's physical and human geography.
- 4.H.CH.1** Identify and examine the Indigenous sovereign people of Oregon prior to and during waves of exploration and settlement from Europe and the United States.
- 4.H.CE.4** Give examples of how changes in Oregon's agricultural, industrial, political, and business development over time affect people of the state including traditionally underrepresented groups.
- 4.H.CP.6** Identify the history, religion, languages, and cultural practices of the Indigenous Tribes of Oregon and examples of resistance and resilience to immigration and settlement by the United States.

Oregon Grade 4 English Language Arts Standards (2026)

- 4.RI.7** Interpret information presented visually, orally, or quantitatively, in print and non-print formats and explain how the information contributes to an understanding of the text in which it appears.
- 4.W.2e** Use precise language and domain-specific vocabulary to inform about or explain the topic.
- 4.L.3a** Choose words and phrases to convey ideas precisely.
- 4.L.6** Acquire and use accurately grade-appropriate general academic and domain-specific words and phrases, including those that signal precise actions, emotions, or states of being and that are basic to a particular topic.
- 4.SL.1** Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions with diverse partners on grade 4 topics and texts, building on others' ideas and expressing personal ideas clearly.
 - 4.SL.1c** Pose and respond to specific questions to clarify or follow up on information, and make comments that contribute to the discussion and link to the remarks of others.
 - 4.SL.1d** Review the key ideas expressed and explain personal ideas and understanding in light of the discussion.
- 4.SL.2** Paraphrase portions of a text read aloud or information presented in diverse media and formats, including visually, quantitatively, and orally.